Lenny's Crispy Chicken

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

Lenny loves crispy chicken, so when he challenged me to make it at home, I couldn't resist.

Serves 4–6 · Prep 20 min · Cook 20 min

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE CHICKEN

- 1 kg boneless chicken breast or thigh, cut into evenly sized strips
- 1 cup plain flour
- 1 tbsp smoked paprika
- ½ tsp salt, or to taste
- 2–3 eggs, beaten
- 1½ cups breadcrumbs or panko, plus extra if needed
- Approximately 2 cups vegetable oil, for shallow-frying, depending on your pan

FOR THE DIPPING SAUCE

- 4 tbsp mayonnaise
- 2 tbsp barbecue sauce, adjusted to taste

METHOD

1. Prepare the chicken. Pat the chicken dry with kitchen paper. Cut into strips of a similar thickness so they cook evenly.
2. Set up the coating. In one shallow bowl, combine the flour, smoked paprika and salt. Place the beaten eggs in a second bowl and the breadcrumbs or panko in a third.
3. Coat the chicken. Dip each piece first into the seasoned flour, shaking off the excess, then into the beaten egg. Finally, press into the breadcrumbs until evenly coated. Arrange on a tray.
4. Heat the oil. Pour enough vegetable oil into a large, deep frying pan to come roughly halfway up the chicken pieces. Heat over medium heat until a breadcrumb dropped into the oil sizzles immediately without burning.
5. Fry in batches. Carefully add the chicken without crowding the pan. Fry for approximately 3–5 minutes per side, depending on thickness, until golden and cooked through. The centre should reach 75°C.
6. Transfer to a wire rack set over a tray to drain while you cook the remaining batches.
7. Make the dip. Stir together the mayonnaise and barbecue sauce, adjusting the proportions to your taste. Serve alongside the hot crispy chicken.

Tip

Follow the coating order. Flour first, then egg, then breadcrumbs helps the crust stick evenly.